

Degree Project Management Tool (/)

MSc Projects - 25/26 (/msc)

A Visual Trace Map of Edinburgh Place Names in Literature

Principal Goal: The goal of this project to design a number of visual static and interactive maps that trace the order and co-occurrence of Edinburgh place names in selected literary works.

This project has been proposed by Uta Hinrichs (/msc/person/10992) (uhinrich@ed.ac.uk (mailto:uhinrich@ed.ac.uk)). You are currently interested in being a **supervisor** for this project.

Advances in computer science (e.g., text mining and information visualization) enable the large-scale exploration of literary collections. Following such approaches, a previous research project – LitLong Edinburgh (<https://www.research.ed.ac.uk/en/publications/litlong-edinburgh-version-20/> (<https://www.research.ed.ac.uk/en/publications/litlong-edinburgh-version-20/>)) – has explored the appearance of real-world Edinburgh place names in literature written by authors such as Robert Louis Stephenson or Mary Shelley. As part of the LitLong project, Edinburgh place names mentioned in literary texts have been extracted along with the corresponding text snippets, book title, author, and publication year. This data is now available through a PostgreSQL database. Previous visualization approaches have visualized this data in the form of interactive maps.

This project will focus on designing more abstract – static and interactive – maps that trace Edinburgh place names, based on selected authors and literary works. These maps should be designed in ways that allow (1) the visual exploration of the order in which place names are mentioned in selected literary works, (2) making visible co-occurrence of certain place names across selected literary works (e.g., works by certain authors), and (3) mechanisms to compare selected literary works, authors or sub-collections based on the sequence of place name mentions.

The project will decidedly move away from mapping location mentions to geographical maps, but explore abstract approaches to mapping location data, considering sequence and frequency. The design of the London Tube map and existing works in this area [2-3] serve as visual inspiration and starting points for design explorations.

While the data for this project – the LitLong database – is provided for this project, the extraction of additional meta data (i.e., information about the order in which place names are mentioned) is required as

part of this project.

- 1 Palimpsest: Improving Assisted Curation of Loco-specific Literature. Alex, B., Grover, C., Oberlander, J., Thomson, T., Anderson, M., Loxley, J., Hinrichs, U. & Zhou, K. In: Digital Scholarship in the Humanities. 32, 1, p. i4-i16, 2017
- 2 Visualizing the spatiality in fictional narratives by Jan-Erik Stange and Marian Dörk. VIS4DH'16: Workshop on Visualization for the Digital Humanities at IEEE VIS, 2016.
- 3 <https://uclab.fh-potsdam.de/projects/novel-city-maps/> (<https://uclab.fh-potsdam.de/projects/novel-city-maps/>)
- 4 The London Tube Map. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tube_map (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tube_map)

Completion Criteria

Implementation of a series of static and/or interactive visualizations that characterize individual and groups of literary works based on their mention of Edinburgh place names – as part of this:

- o Design explorations (sketches) of visualizations that map sequences of location mentions in 2D space.
- o Enhancing existing the LitLong database with data on the sequence of location mentions in a given literary work.

Additional Information

Difficulty

Variable

Capacity

Maximum of 3 students.

Popularity

10 students are interested in this project.

Desirable Skills

Experience in working with databases, web-programming skills, and working with visualization libraries such as D3.js is desirable.

Essential Skills

Essential for this project is a passion for visualization design, in particular, for visualizing data in non-standard, artistic ways. Some experience with analyzing textual data is also a requirement.

Resources Required

LitLong database (provided by supervisor)

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